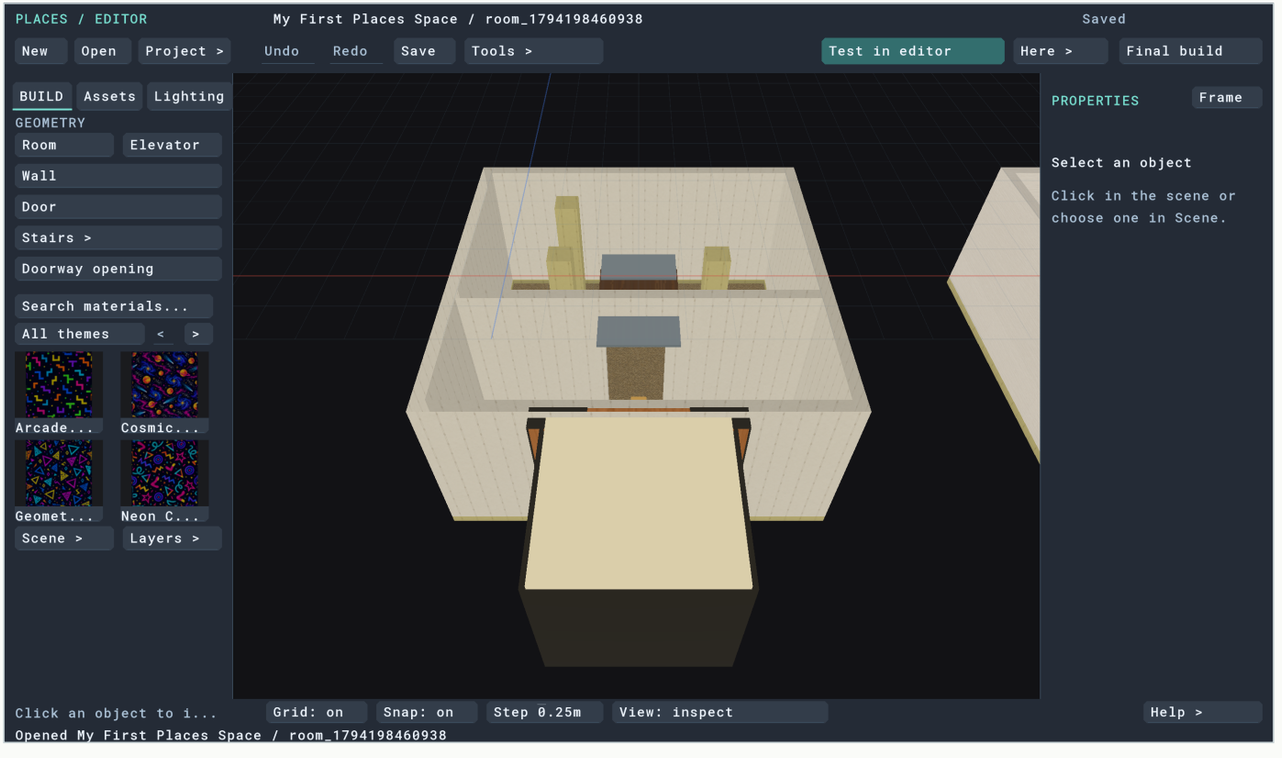
Beginner’s Guide to Your First Places Space

A practical, illustrated walkthrough • native macOS editor captures • keyboard equivalents for Windows



Actual native Places 0.13.1 editor capture.

CHECKPOINT Keep this PDF beside the editor. Work through the numbered pages in order; save at each checkpoint.

Build a small world you can explore.

Start with an empty project. Enclose a Backrooms room, furnish it, then link it by elevator to a Home room and a Pool room.

Along the way you will make walls, an open doorway, doors, pillars, lights, furniture and water.

For Places 0.13.1.
No previous editor experience needed. No entities or Luau required.

01 Plan your three rooms

One level, three rooms, three linked elevator cabins. The rooms sit side by side on the same floor. The elevator makes them feel like separate destinations; no extra project levels or scripts are needed.

A room supplies a floor and ceiling. **It does not supply walls.** You will build the enclosing walls explicitly, then add interior partitions.

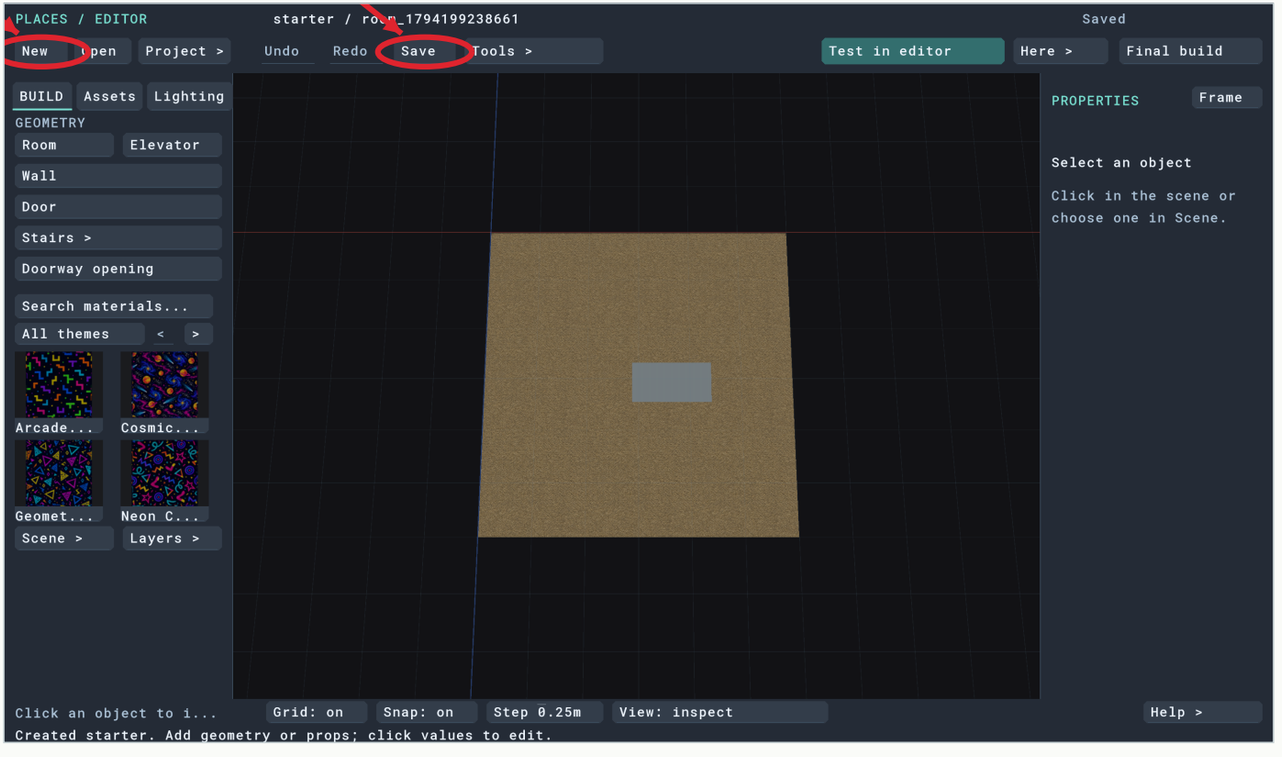
Metres: X runs left/right, Z runs across the floor, and Y is height. Room and wall X/Z values locate their minimum corner. Props use their placement origin. Keep floors at Y = 0 and ceilings at 2.7 m.

The route: Backrooms → elevator → Home → elevator → Pool → elevator → Backrooms. The pool is shallow; the duck sits on its bench.

Area	Floor rectangle	Main contents
Backrooms	X 0, Z 0; 6 × 6 m	Desk, chair, three pillars, open doorway
Home	X 10, Z 0; 6 × 6 m	Bed, kitchen, partition with door
Pool	X 20, Z 0; 8 × 8 m	Shallow basin, bench, duck, janitor closet

CHECKPOINT Leave the gaps between rooms empty. The elevator cabins occupy space behind each room’s south wall.

02 Start a new project



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Open **places-editor** (Windows: **places-editor.exe**). Keep the installation's assets folder and compiler in their supplied locations.

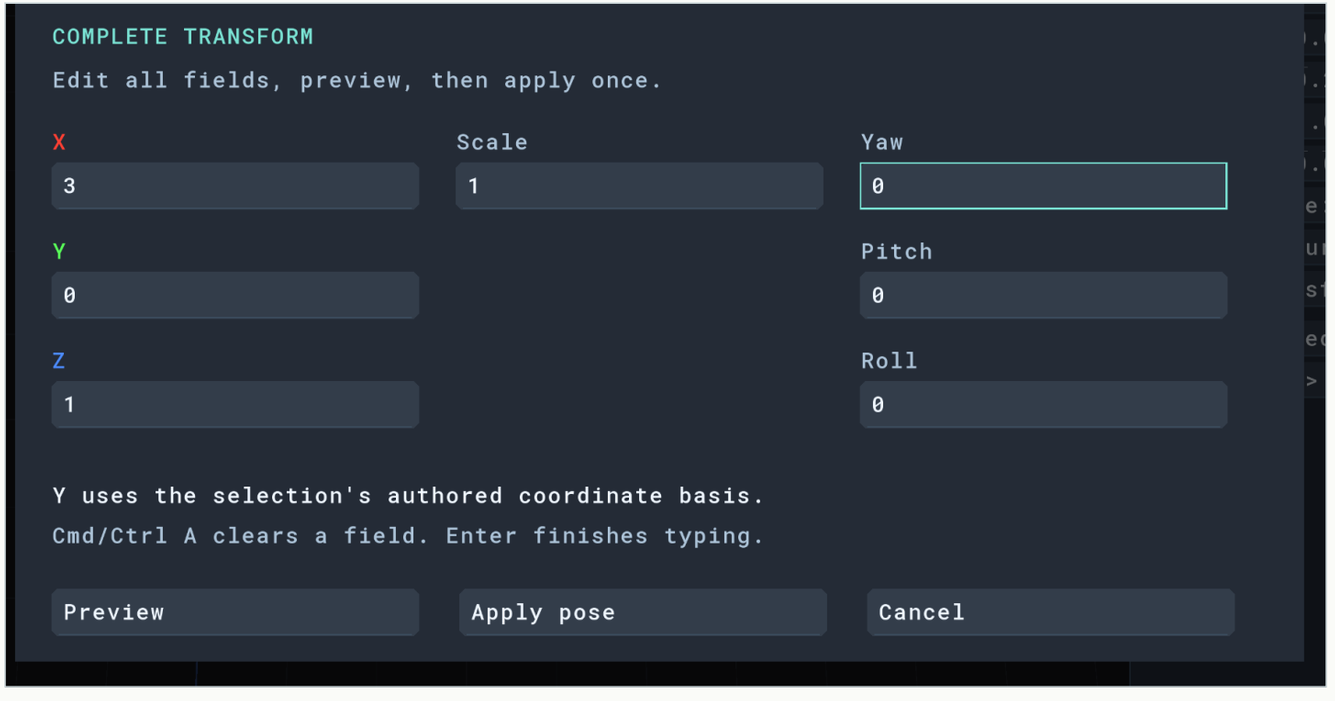
2. Click **New**. Choose a writable parent folder, such as Documents. The editor creates a new child project inside it.

3. The starter is a **6 × 6 m room** with one ceiling light and no walls. Its spawn is at X 3, Z 4.5.

4. Click **Save**. Keep the whole project folder; its JSON source is what you edit.

CHECKPOINT You should see a square floor, a ceiling fixture and the Build / Assets / Lighting tabs. If you cannot see the room, press F to frame it.

03 Learn the view and number fields



Actual native Places 0.13.1 editor capture.

Move the view: right-drag orbits; middle-drag pans; the wheel zooms. Hold right mouse and W/A/S/D to fly; Q/E moves down/up.

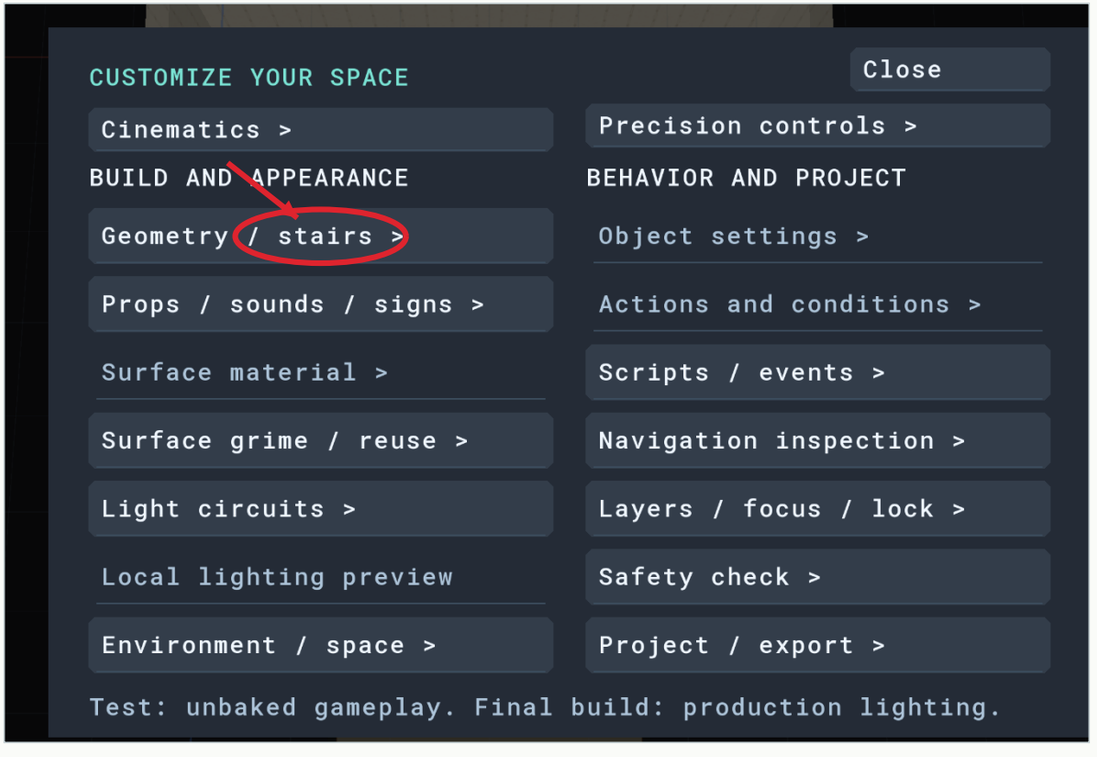
Select: click an object. Its outline and properties appear. Press F or click Frame to centre it. Scene opens a searchable list.

Enter a value: click the field, press Cmd+A on Mac or Ctrl+A on Windows, type, then Enter.

Precise edits: Exact transform opens all pose fields. Preview shows the result; Apply pose commits it. Escape cancels a draft.

CHECKPOINT Cmd/Ctrl+Z undoes a completed edit. Cmd/Ctrl+S saves. Do not rely on the apparent screen distance: use the supplied numeric values.

04 Find the wall tools



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

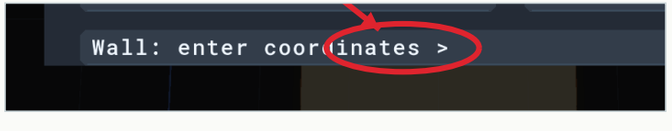
1. Click **Tools >** in the top bar.

2. Choose **Geometry / stairs >**. Then choose **Wall: enter coordinates >** at the bottom of that sheet.

3. This guide uses numeric walls so every room and doorway can be reproduced exactly.

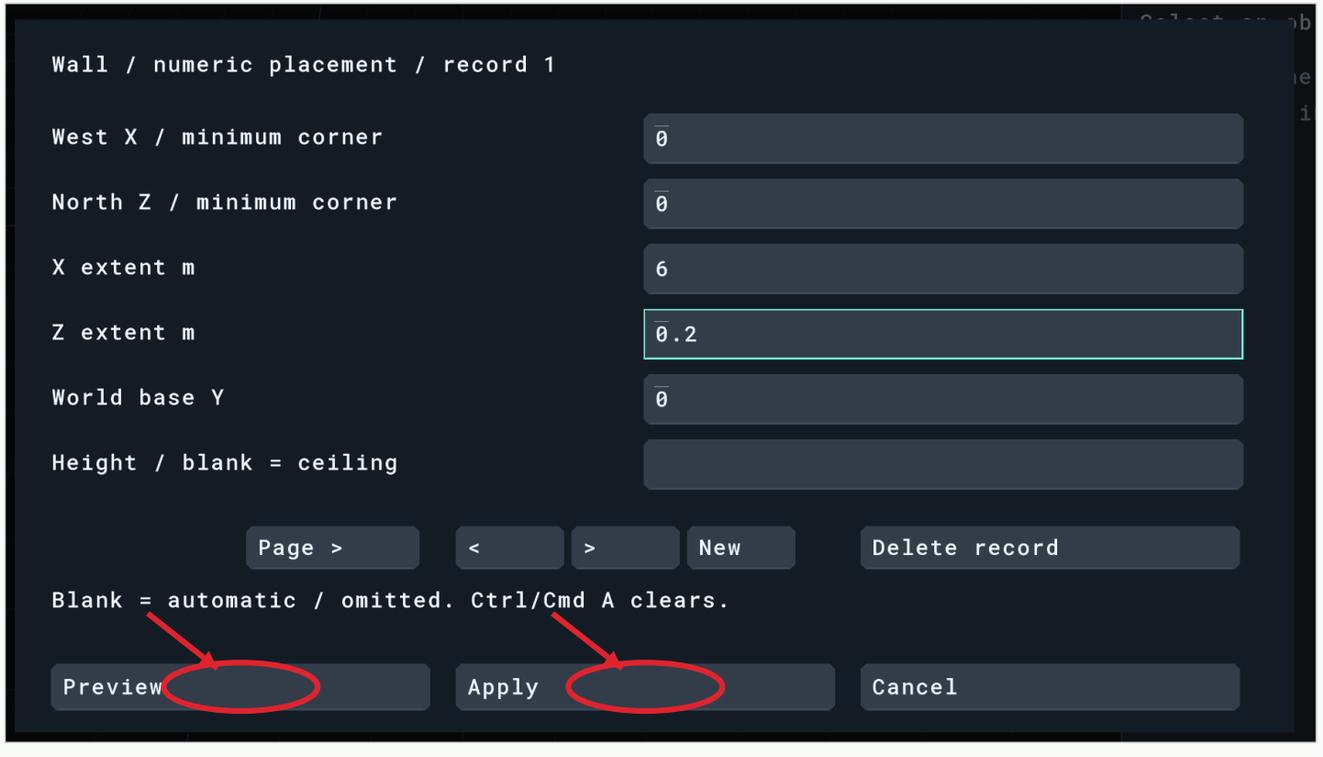
For freehand work later: Build > Wall starts a wall on a floor click. A second click ends it. Chain continues connected segments; Escape stops.

CHECKPOINT The numeric form is titled Wall / numeric placement. It has X, Z, two extents, base Y and height. The next page gives the first four walls.



Inside Geometry / stairs
Choose Wall: enter coordinates to open the six-field form on the next page.

05 Enclose the Backrooms room



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Fill the first row of the table below. Leave **World base Y = 0** and **Height blank** so the wall follows the ceiling.

2. Click **Preview**, then **Apply**. The wall becomes part of your scene.

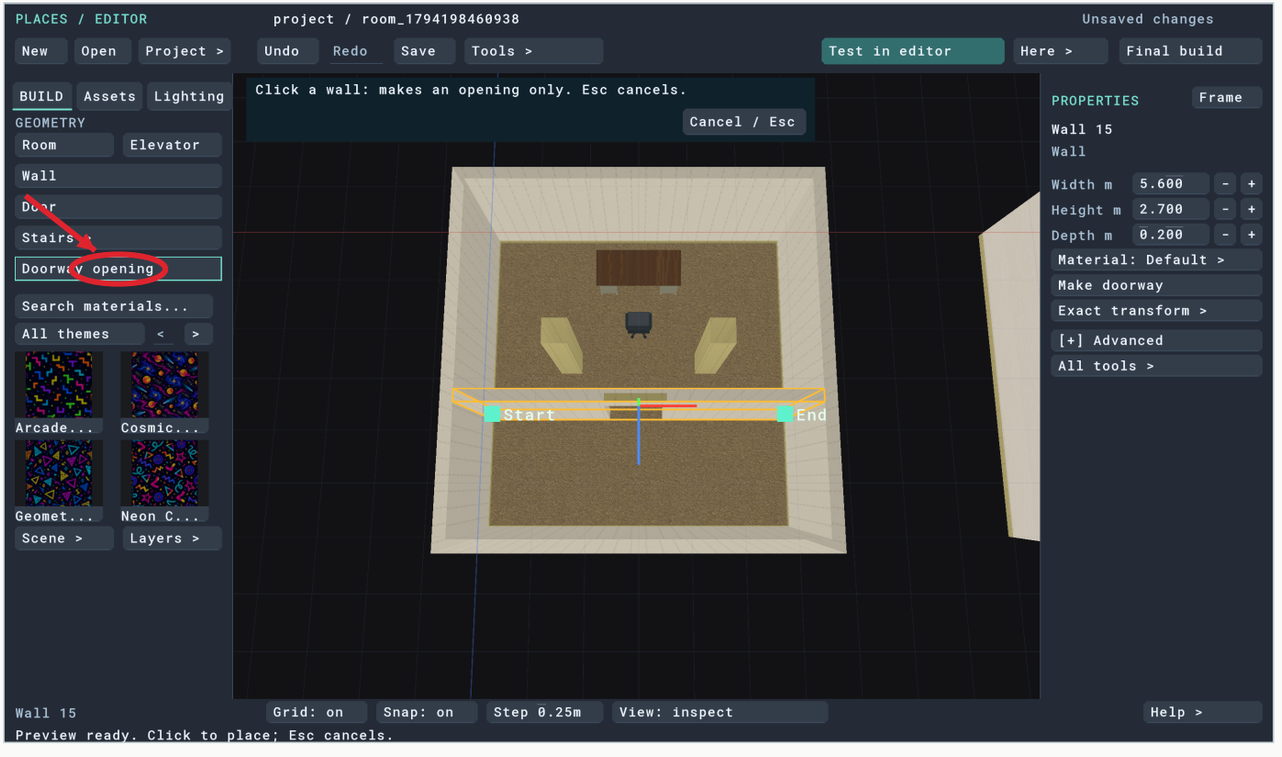
3. Reopen Tools > Geometry / stairs > Wall: enter coordinates for each remaining row. Each opening of that command creates a new wall.

4. Leave the second-page material blank here: the default is the yellow Backrooms wallpaper. Save.

Wall	West X	North Z	X extent	Z extent
North	0	0	6	0.2
South	0	5.8	6	0.2
West	0	0.2	0.2	5.6
East	5.8	0.2	0.2	5.6

CHECKPOINT Four walls meet without overlapping corners. Looking down hides the ceiling so you can inspect the inside.

06 Make an open doorway



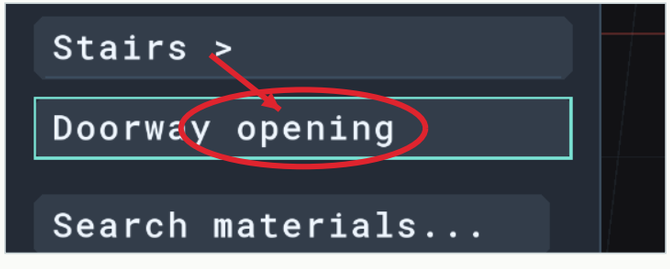
Doorway preview on the partition. This reference view already includes furniture added in later steps.

1. Add one more numeric wall: **X 0.2, Z 3.6, X extent 5.6, Z extent 0.2**. Keep base Y 0 and height blank.

2. This partition splits the room into a furnished area and a small elevator lobby.

3. Choose **Build > Doorway opening**. Point at the partition near its centre, X 3. You should see an opening preview.

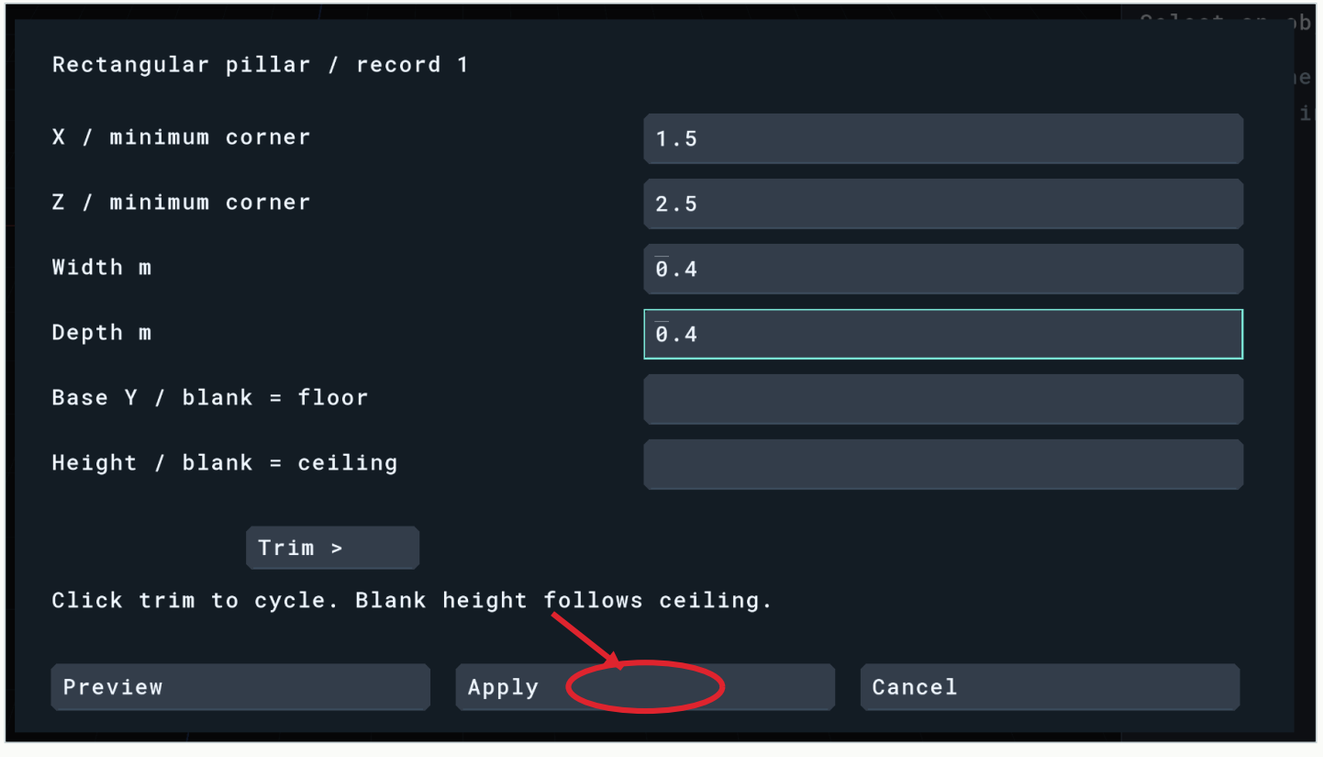
4. Click to cut the opening. This makes an **open passage**; no door leaf is added. Save.



CHECKPOINT Check that you can see through the partition. An opening belongs to its wall: do not delete the wall to make a doorway.

Control close-up
This is a magnified crop of the same native screenshot. Match the tab and command label before clicking.

07 Add three pillars



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Open **Tools > Geometry / stairs > Rectangular pillar**.

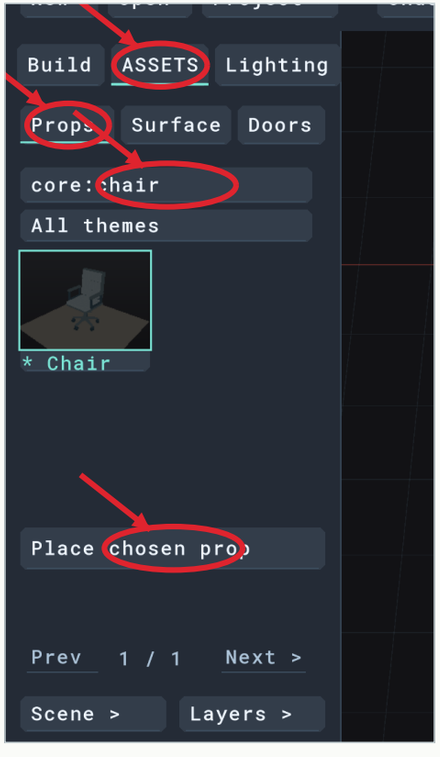
2. Enter **X 1.5, Z 2.5, Width 0.4, Depth 0.4**. Leave Base Y and Height blank: the pillar spans floor to ceiling.

3. Click **Preview**, then **Apply**. Reopen Rectangular pillar to create the second one.

4. Repeat at **X 4.1, Z 2.5**, then at **X 1.5, Z 1**. Use the same 0.4 × 0.4 m footprint for all three. Save.

CHECKPOINT There is a clear centre route between the three pillars and through the doorway. Keep that path free of furniture.

08a Choose a furnishing prop

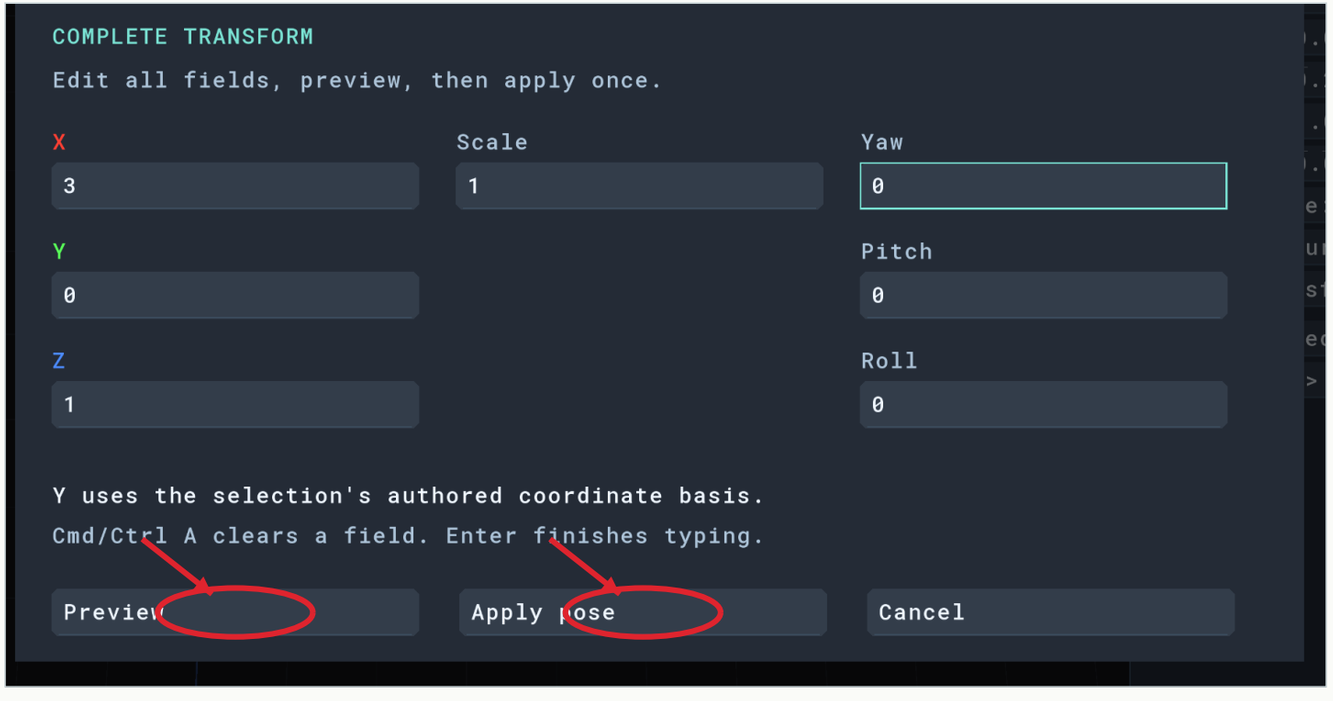


Magnified native catalog view. The captured example has core:chair selected; use core:desk first.

1. Click an empty patch of room floor to clear any prop selection.
2. Open the **Assets** tab, then choose **Props**. The search box now filters models.
3. Click the search box. Press Cmd/Ctrl+A, type **core:desk**, then Enter. Click the matching tile.
4. Click **Place chosen prop**. It appears near your view target. Use the next page to set its exact position.

CHECKPOINT Do not click a new model tile while another prop is selected unless you intend to replace that prop. Select clear floor first.

08b Place the desk and chair



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. From above, click **empty floor**. Open Assets, choose Props, and search for **core:desk**. Click its tile, then **Place chosen prop**.

2. The new prop appears near the view target. With it selected, click **Exact transform >**. Enter the desk values below, Preview, then Apply pose.

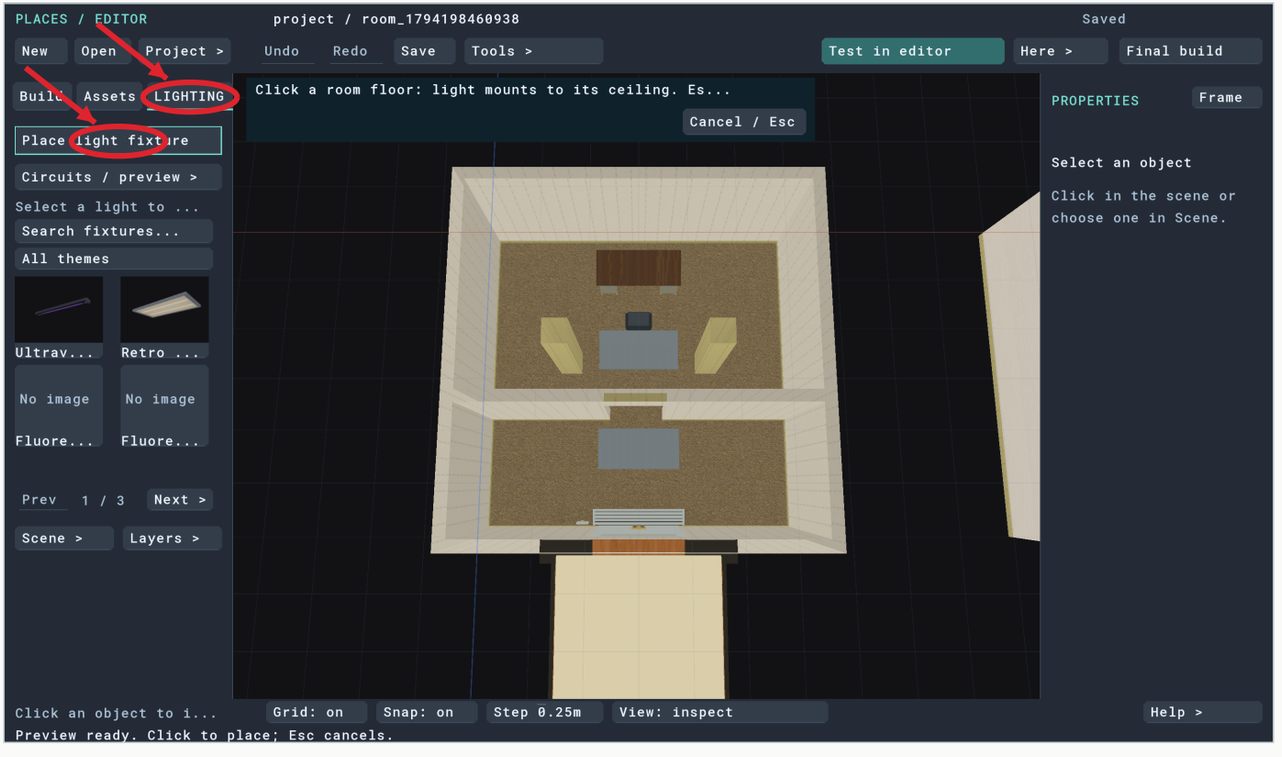
3. Click empty floor again before searching for **core:chair**. Place it and enter the chair values.

Important: choosing a model while a prop is selected replaces that prop. Selecting floor first protects your existing furniture.

Prop / search ID	X	Y	Z	Scale / Yaw
core:desk	3	0	1	1 / 0°
core:chair	3	0	2	1 / 180°

CHECKPOINT Keep Pitch and Roll at 0. Prop Y is above the supporting floor; ordinary floor furniture uses Y = 0.

09 Light the Backrooms lobby



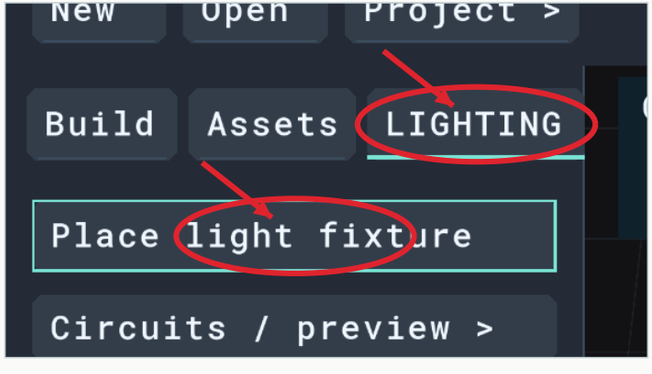
Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. The starter light already illuminates the furnished side. Add a second fixture for the space behind the partition.

2. Click the **Lighting** tab, then **Place light fixture**. Point at the lobby floor near **X 3, Z 4.6**.

3. The preview places a real fixture at the ceiling above that floor point. Click to place it; Escape cancels an unfinished placement.

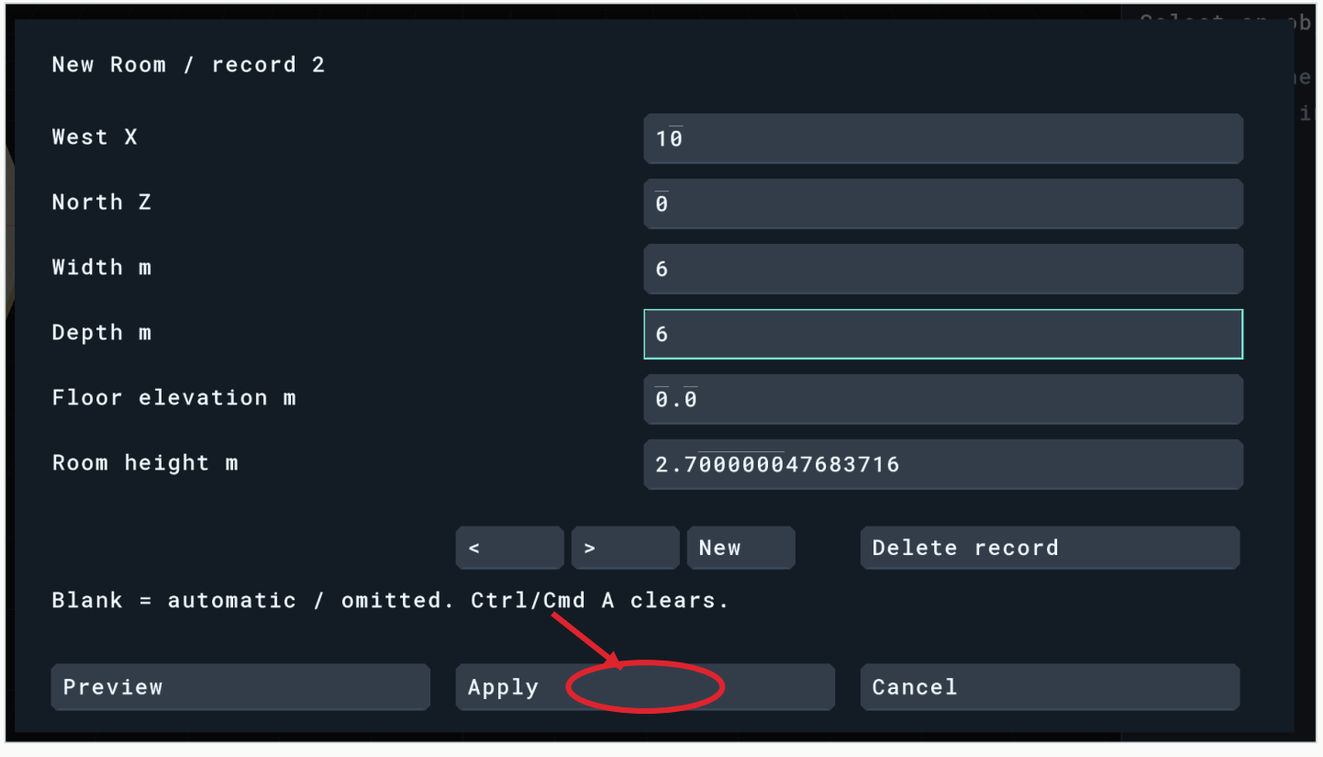
4. Select it to inspect its power, range and colour. Keep the defaults for now, then Save.



CHECKPOINT Inspect view uses neutral editing light. Test in editor uses approximate lighting; the final build computes the finished lighting and shadows.

Control close-up
This is a magnified crop of the same native screenshot. Match the tab and command label before clicking.

10 Create the Home room



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Choose **Build > Room**. In the room form enter West X 10, North Z 0, Width 6, Depth 6, Floor elevation 0 and Room height 2.7.

2. Click Preview, then Apply. This is a new floor and ceiling, with no automatic walls.

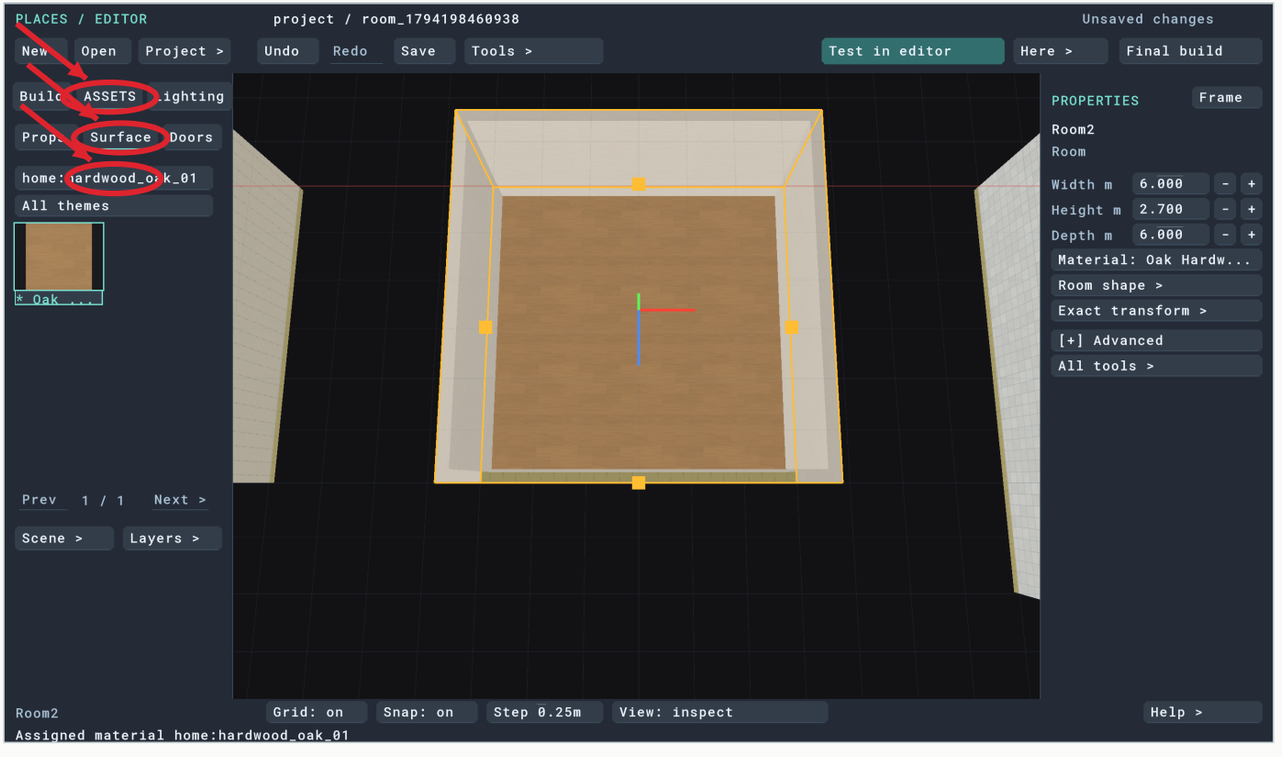
3. Enclose it using the four numeric wall rows below. Base Y stays 0; Height stays blank.

4. For each wall click **Page >** and set its material to **home:wall_paint_offwhite_01** before Preview / Apply.

Wall	West X	North Z	X extent	Z extent
North	10	0	6	0.2
South	10	5.8	6	0.2
West	10	0.2	0.2	5.6
East	15.8	0.2	0.2	5.6

CHECKPOINT Both rooms have the same floor elevation. Their four-metre separation leaves room for independent enclosure.

11 Give Home its own surfaces



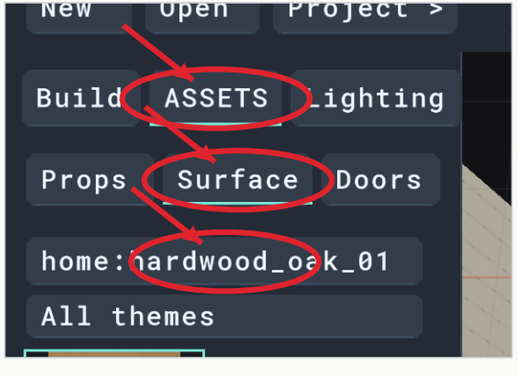
Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Orbit to a steep overhead view. Click clear floor inside Home. Confirm the properties describe a **Room**, not a wall or prop.

2. Choose **Assets > Surface**. Search **home:hardwood_oak_01** and click its tile to apply it to the floor.

3. To change a ceiling, select the room, then open **Tools > Surface material >**. Click the Surface / Ceiling switch to choose Ceiling.

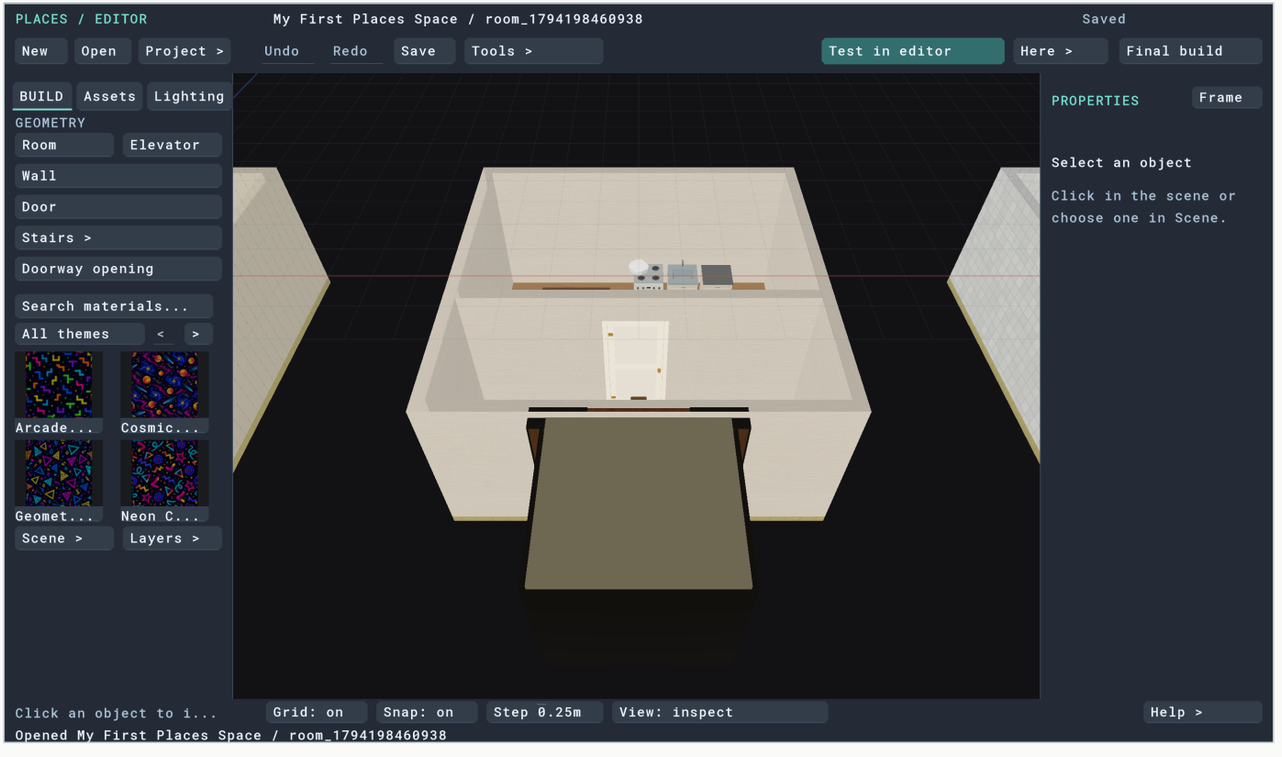
4. Search **home:ceiling_white_01** and choose its tile. Reopen the picker and switch back to Surface before later floor assignments.



CHECKPOINT Material IDs are exact catalog search terms. If you see no results, clear the search with Cmd/Ctrl+A and check that All themes is selected.

Control close-up
This is a magnified crop of the same native screenshot. Match the tab and command label before clicking.

12 Furnish the Home room



Actual native Places 0.13.1 editor capture.

1. Repeat the Assets > Props workflow. Select empty floor before choosing each new model.

2. Use Place chosen prop, then Exact transform. Enter each row below with Scale 1, Yaw 0, Pitch 0 and Roll 0.

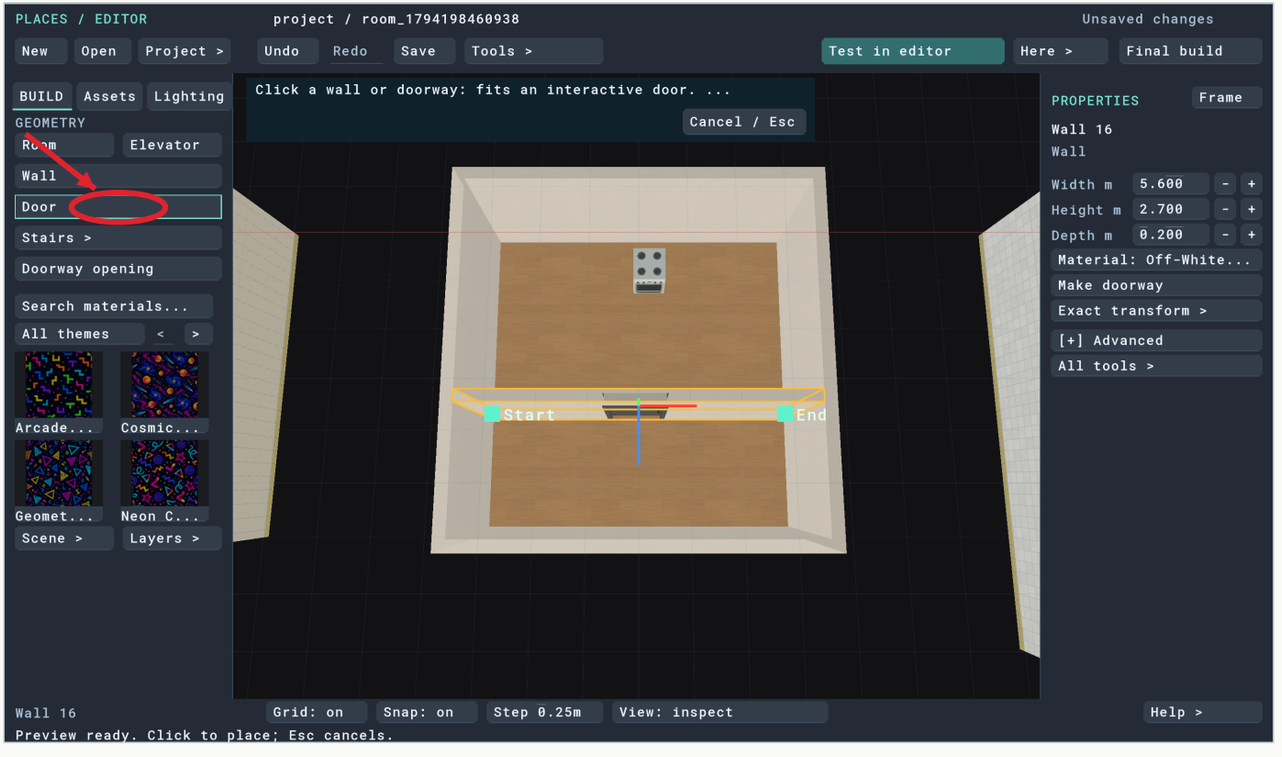
3. The cabinet, sink unit and cooker form a small kitchen along the north wall; the bed sits to its left.

4. Add Home’s ceiling light using the numeric fixture workflow in Step 19. Save before continuing.

Model search ID	X	Y	Z
core:bed	11.7	0	2
home:cabinet_base	14.6	0	1
home:sink	13.9	0	1
home:stove	13.2	0	1

CHECKPOINT Leave room to stand in front of the kitchen. These are static furnishing props; no interaction components are required.

13 Fit a door in Home



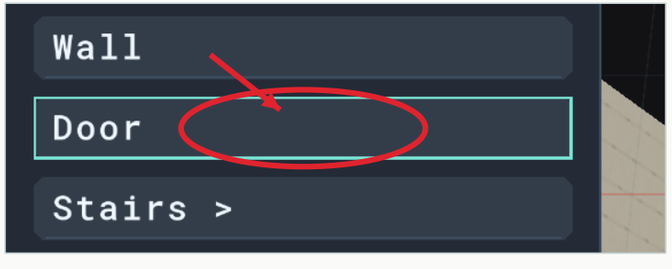
Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Add a partition wall at **X 10.2, Z 3.6**, with X extent 5.6 and Z extent 0.2. Use Home’s wall material.

2. Choose **Build > Door**. Point at the centre of the partition, around **X 13**.

3. Inspect the preview, then click. Door creates a fitted opening **and** an interactive door leaf in one action.

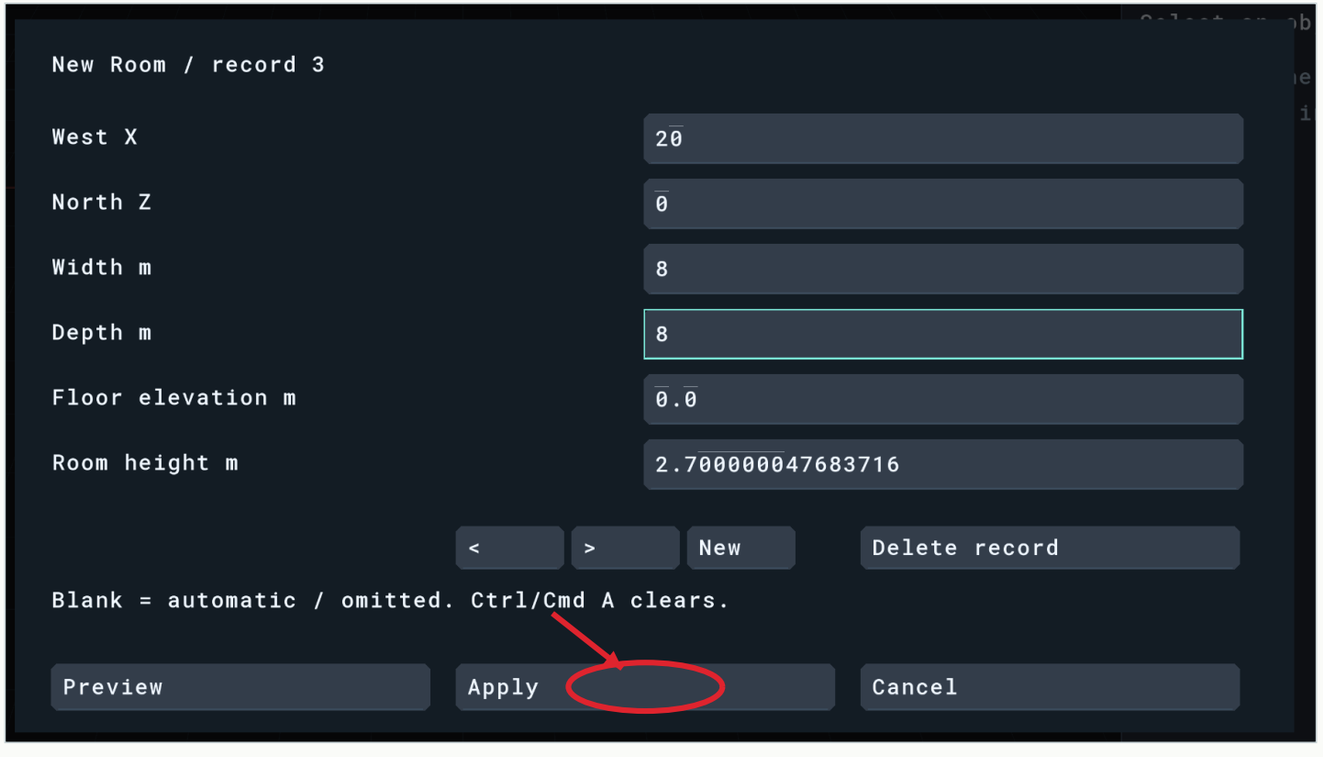
4. Keep the initial door style. In play, press E to open, step back while it swings, then centre yourself in the opening and walk through.



CHECKPOINT Doorway opening (Step 6) cuts only a hole. Door adds the leaf too, and can also fit a leaf into a suitable existing doorway.

Control close-up
This is a magnified crop of the same native screenshot. Match the tab and command label before clicking.

14 Build the Pool room shell



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Build > Room: enter **X 20, Z 0, Width 8, Depth 8, Floor elevation 0, Height 2.7**. Preview and Apply.

2. Add the four walls below. On their second form page, set **core:pool_tile_wall_01**. Base Y is 0; Height is blank.

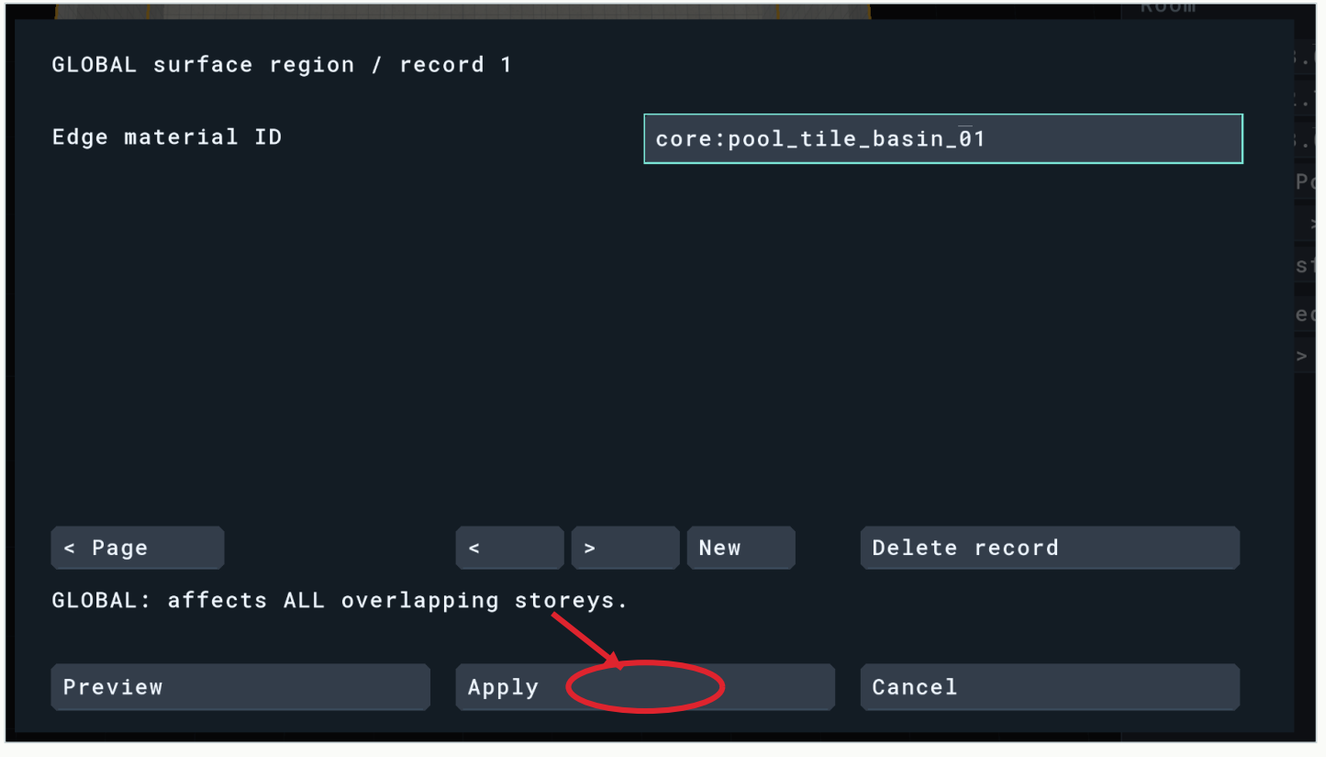
3. Select the floor and assign **core:pool_tile_deck_01** through Assets > Surface.

4. Through the room's Surface material picker, switch to Ceiling and assign **core:pool_ceiling_01**. Switch back to Surface afterwards.

Wall	West X	North Z	X extent	Z extent
North	20	0	8	0.2
South	20	7.8	8	0.2
West	20	0.2	0.2	7.6
East	27.8	0.2	0.2	7.6

CHECKPOINT Keep the room floor at Y = 0. The next step lowers only the basin area.

15 Recess the shallow pool basin



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

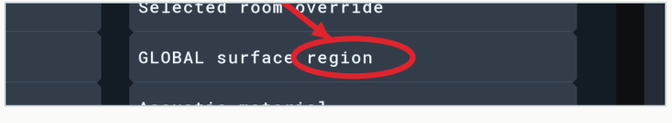
1. Open **Tools > Environment / space >**, then **GLOBAL surface region**.

2. Enter **X 21.5, Z 2, Width 3, Depth 3**. Set **Offset on ALL carriers = -0.4**.

3. Set Surface material ID to **core:pool_tile_basin_01**. On Page >, set Edge material ID to the same value.

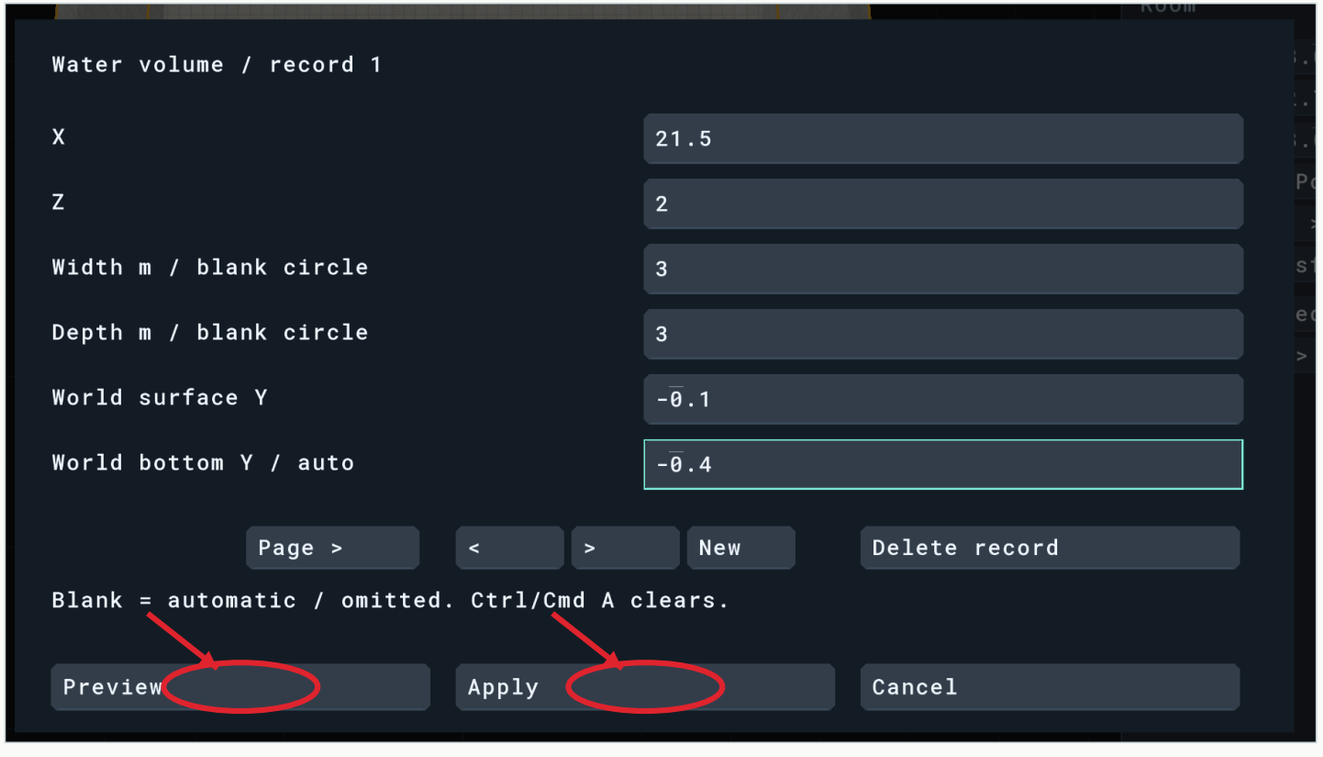
4. Preview and Apply. The basin is now 40 cm below the deck. This operation changes solid floor geometry; it does not add water.

CHECKPOINT This deliberately shallow basin stays within the player's 0.45 m step allowance. Global regions affect overlapping floor carriers, so do not stack another room over this tutorial basin.



Inside Environment / space
Choose GLOBAL surface region. This edits the floor geometry beneath the water.

16 Fill the basin with water

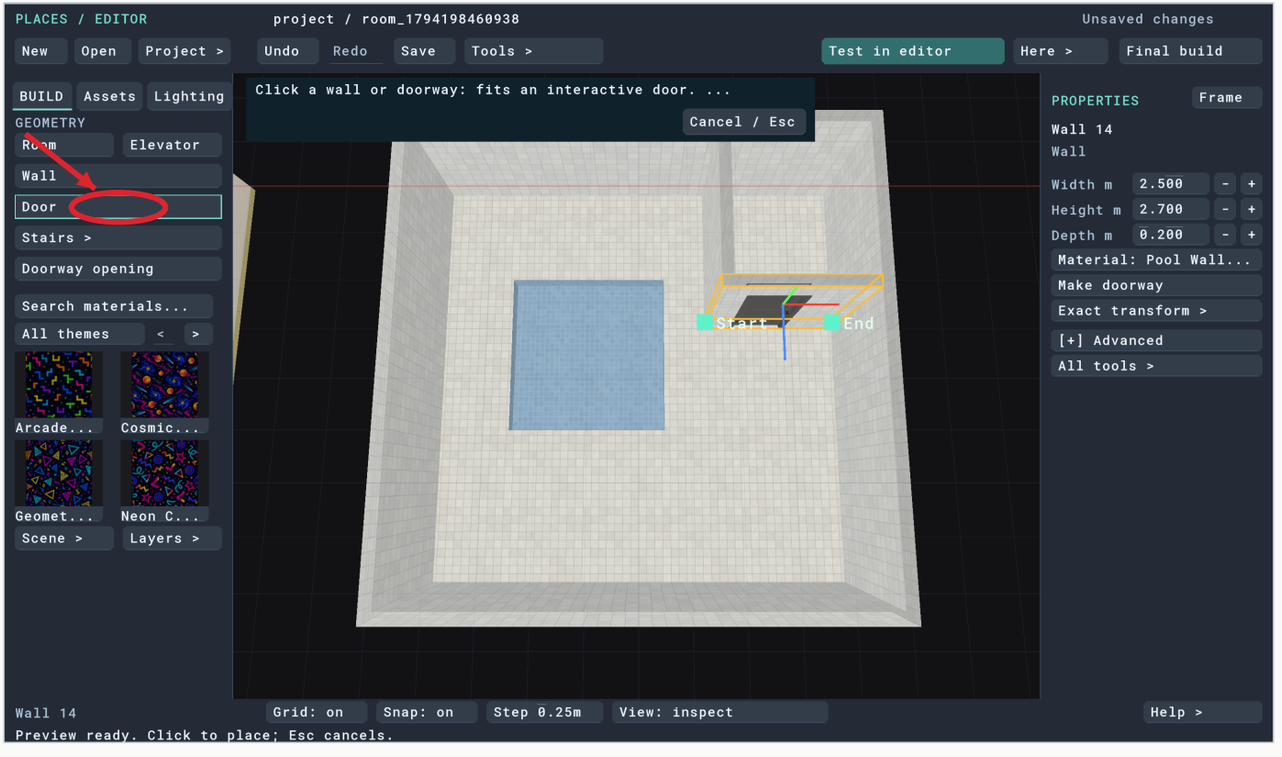


Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Open **Tools > Environment / space > Water volume**.
2. Match the basin: **X 21.5, Z 2, Width 3, Depth 3**.
3. Set **World surface Y = -0.1** and **World bottom Y = -0.4**. Keep the remaining default settings.
4. Preview and Apply. The water surface sits 10 cm below the deck, with 30 cm of water above the basin floor. Save.

CHECKPOINT Water is separate from the solid basin. Keep its footprint inside the recess; water by itself does not make a hole or a supporting floor.

17 Make a small janitor closet



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Reserve the northeast corner of the Pool room. Two new walls use the existing north and east walls to enclose a closet.

2. Add the two numeric walls below with **core:pool_tile_wall_01**. Keep base Y 0 and Height blank.

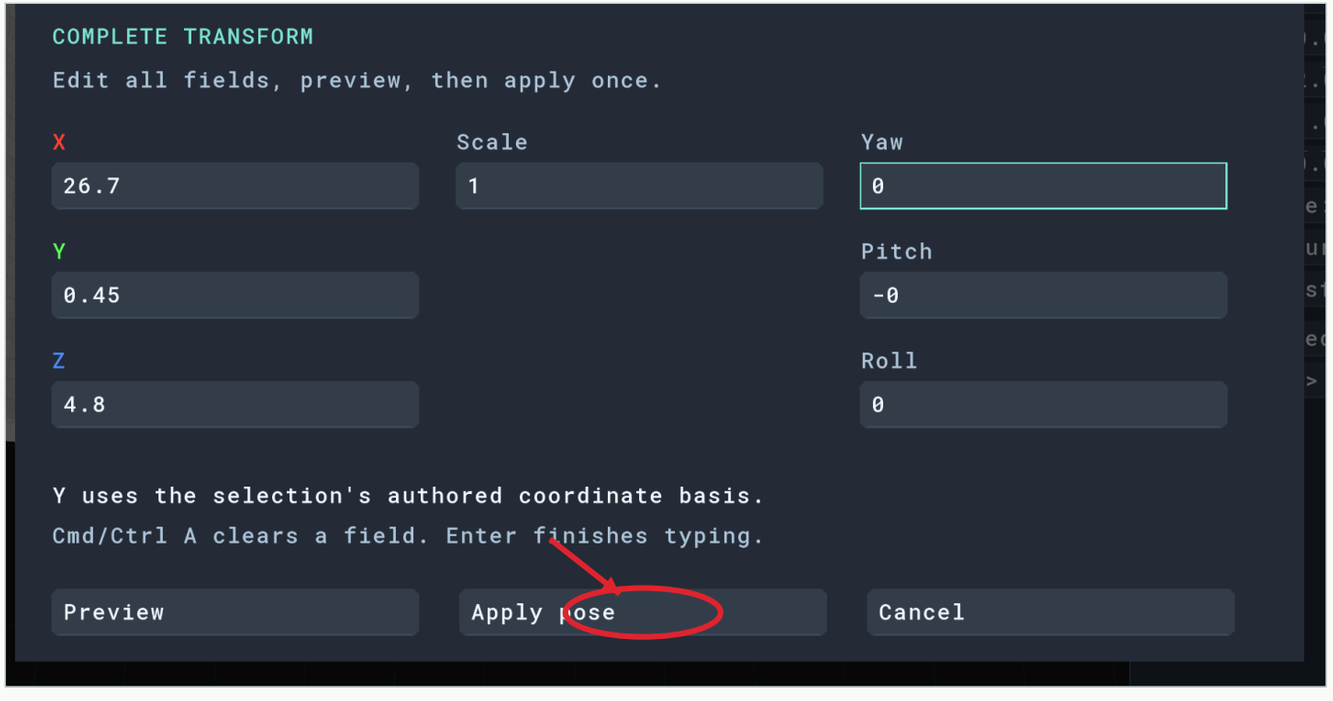
3. Choose **Build > Door**. Point at the closet's south wall near **X 26.5, Z 2.8**. Check the preview and click.

4. Add the fixture in Step 19. In play, open with E, step back, then centre yourself in the opening before walking in. The swing can nudge you sideways.

Closet wall	West X	North Z	X extent	Z extent
West partition	25.3	0.2	0.2	2.6
South partition	25.3	2.8	2.5	0.2

CHECKPOINT The closet uses the Pool room's existing floor and ceiling. Do not place a second coplanar room inside it.

18 Add the bench and rubber duck



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Select clear floor, search **pool:pool_bench** in Assets > Props, and place it. Apply the bench pose below.

2. Select clear floor again, search **core:rubber_duck**, and place it. Use Exact transform to apply the duck pose.

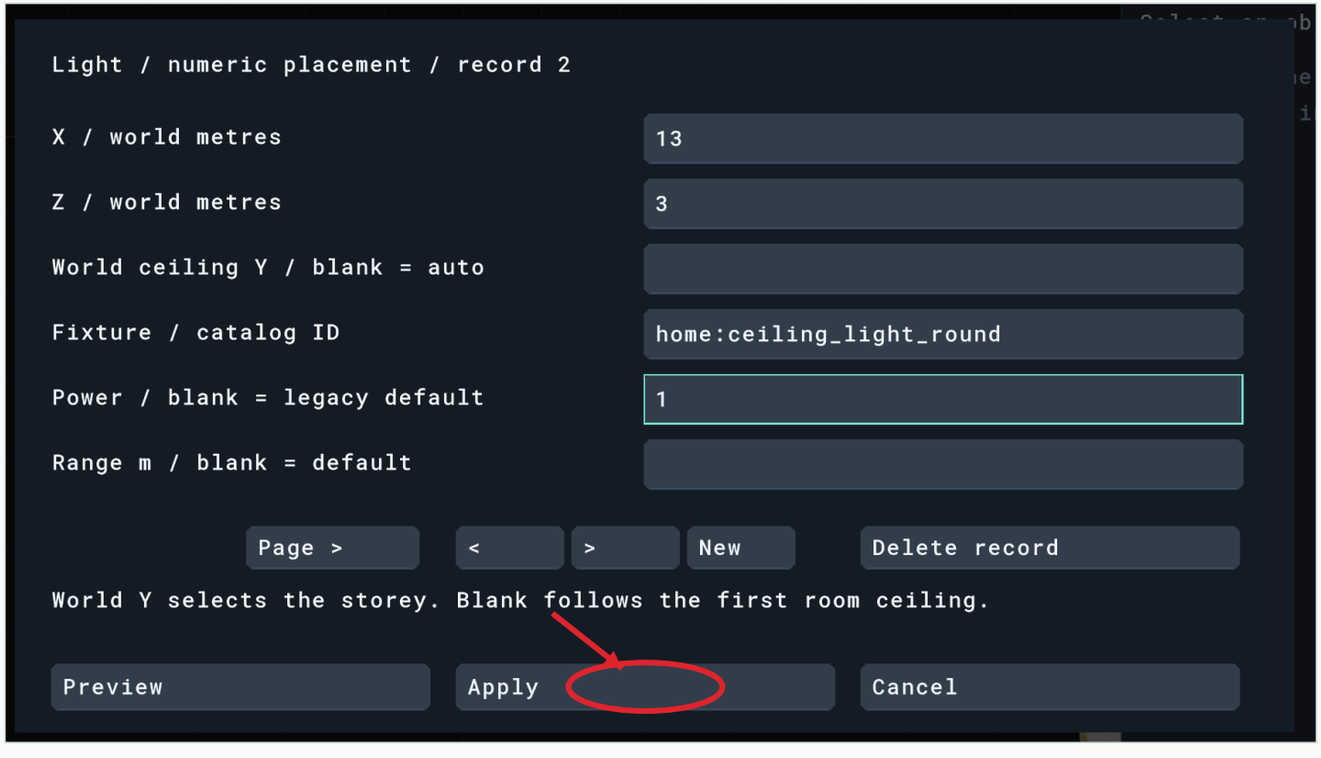
3. The duck sits on the bench at **Y 0.45**. This is a static decoration; no floating behaviour or script is needed.

4. Save, then check the side view: bench feet touch the deck, and the duck rests on the seat.

Model	X	Y	Z	Scale / Yaw
pool:pool_bench	26.7	0	5	1 / 90°
core:rubber_duck	26.7	0.45	4.8	1 / 0°

CHECKPOINT Keep Pitch and Roll at 0. The duck is small at its real catalog scale; zoom in rather than enlarging it.

19 Light Home, Pool and closet



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Open **Tools > Environment / space > Light / numeric placement**. The form provides exact placement and fixture IDs.

2. Click **New** to add a fixture. Enter the first row below. Leave **World ceiling Y blank** for automatic ceiling mounting. Set Power to 1; leave Range blank.

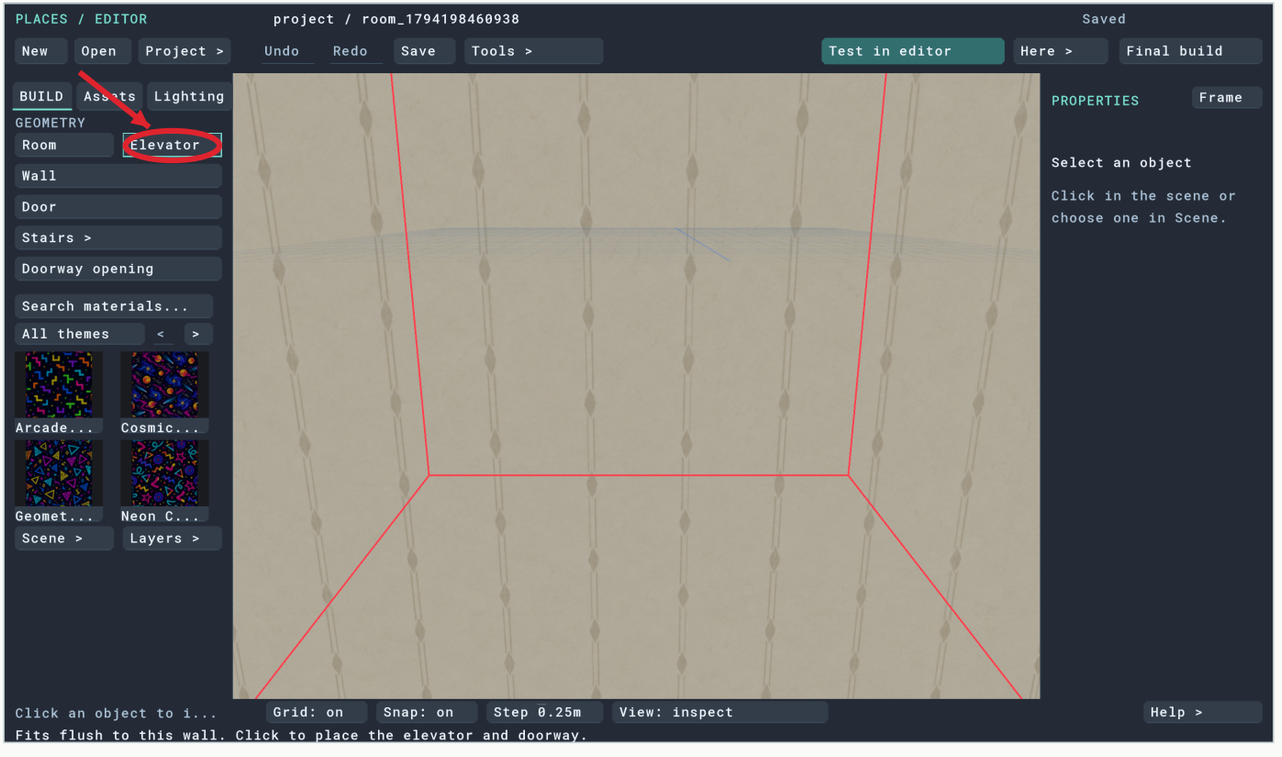
3. Preview and Apply. To add another fixture, reopen the form and choose **New** before entering the next row.

4. Repeat for the Pool room and closet, then Save. Each enclosed area now has a fixture.

Area	X	Z	Fixture / catalog ID
Home	13	3	home:ceiling_light_round
Pool	23	4	core:pool_light_round
Closet	26.5	1.5	core:pool_light_round

CHECKPOINT Leave Alignment at none and Yaw at 0. A decorative lamp model is not a substitute for a placed light fixture.

20 Place three elevator cabins



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Go inside the Backrooms lobby and face its south wall. Choose **Build > Elevator**.

2. Point near **X 3, Z 5.8** on that wall. The preview fits the cabin and opening to the actual wall face. Click to place.

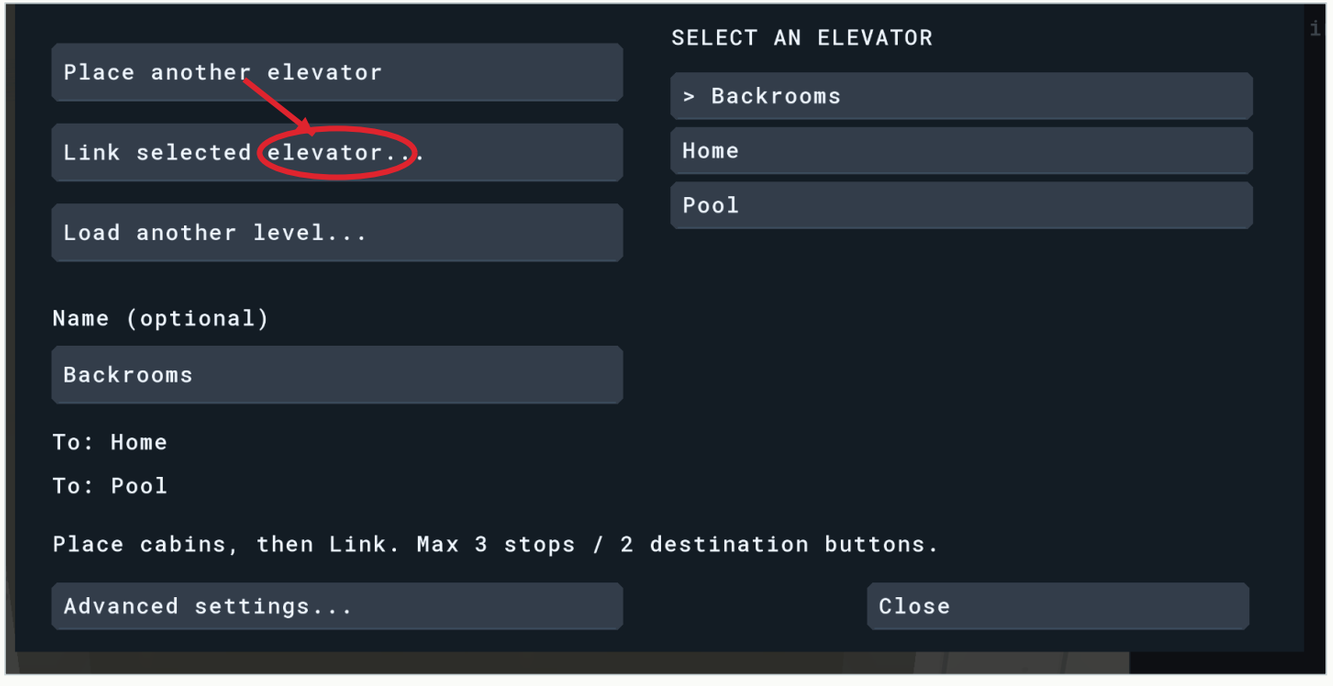
3. In the elevator sheet choose **Name**, type Backrooms and press Enter. Close the sheet.

4. Repeat in Home at **X 13, Z 5.8** and Pool at **X 24, Z 7.8**. Name those stops Home and Pool.

CHECKPOINT Place from the room side so the cabin extends behind the wall. The fitted opening is 1.50 × 2.25 m. Keep each cabin’s doorway and the space behind the wall clear.

Control close-up
This is a magnified crop of the same native screenshot. Match the tab and command label before clicking.

21 Link the elevator destinations



Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

1. Choose **Build > Elevator**, then click the Backrooms cabin to open its sheet. Choose **Link selected**, move to Home, and click Home's cabin.

2. The connection is bidirectional. In the cabin sheet, select Backrooms from the cabin list and choose Link selected again.

3. Click the Pool cabin. The group now contains all three stops; each cabin has the other two as destinations.

4. Save. Reopen the project later to confirm the links persist. Do not add a fourth cabin to this group.

CHECKPOINT The current linked group supports three cabins. These three rooms share one level, so no Allowed transitions list or cross-level destination setup is needed.

22 Save and test your space

Actual native Places 0.13.1 editor capture.

1. Click Save or press **Cmd/Ctrl+S**. Then click **Test in editor** to start at the authored spawn.

2. Walk through the open Backrooms doorway. Check the chair and pillars do not block your route.

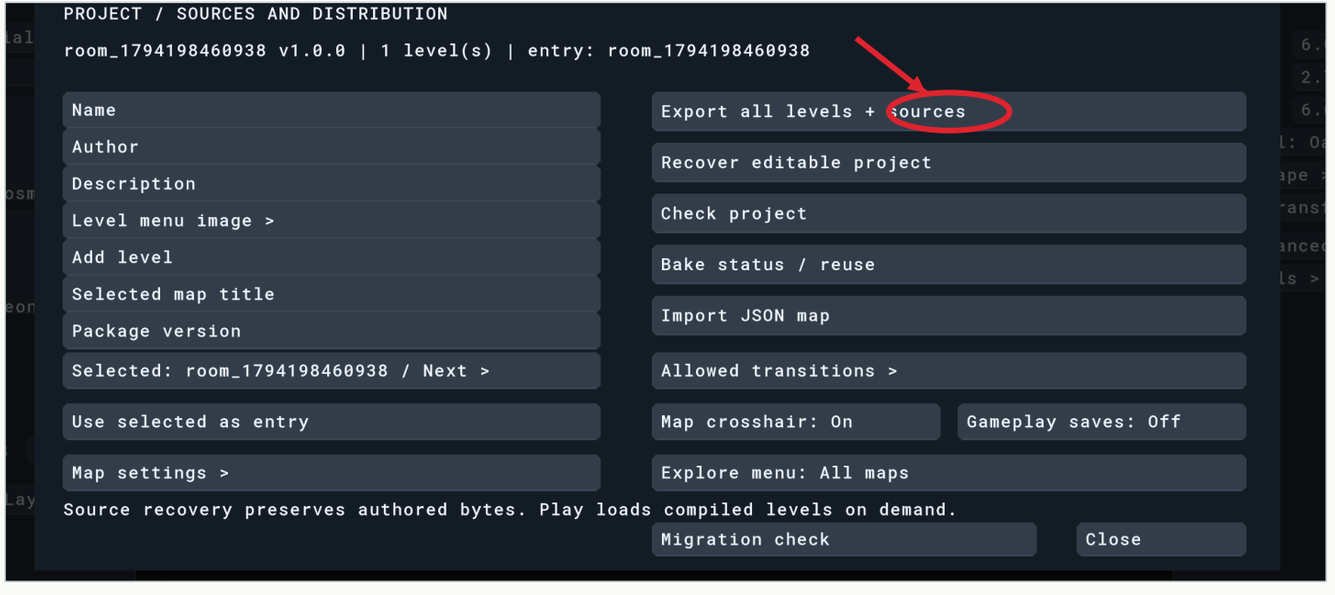
3. Test Home’s door and the closet door with E. Check the pool edge and bench placement. Use Here > a floor pick to start a separate local test near another room if needed.

4. Press **Escape** to stop and return to editing. Quick testing is temporary; it does not save source or bake final lighting.

Movement	Interaction	Editor return
W/A/S/D; mouse look; Space jump	E use / pick up / drop; F flashlight	Escape stops the test
Ctrl crouches	Left click throws a held item	Cmd/Ctrl+S saves source after editing

CHECKPOINT Use the exported player build for the final elevator round trip. Quick tests are useful for local collision and door checks, not proof of final lighting.

23 Compile and export



1. Stop testing. Click **Final build**. It saves dirty levels and compiles the selected level with production lighting.

2. Wait for success. The progress bar describes the **current pass**, not the whole job. Fix any reported error before continuing.

3. Open **Project > Export all levels + sources**. Enter a full, absolute file path ending in **.placesmap** in a writable folder.

4. Apply and wait for successful export. Keep the editable project folder too. Source saves and compiled packages serve different purposes.

Native Places 0.13.1 editor. Red circles and arrows mark the controls named in the steps.

CHECKPOINT Example on Mac: /Users/your-name/Documents/first-space.placesmap. On Windows: C:/Users/your-name/Documents/first-space.placesmap. Replace your-name with your account folder.

24 Play the finished route

The compiled tutorial in the player: elevator destination buttons inside the cabin.

1. Open Places. In **Explore**, import your exported .placesmap, select it, then Play.

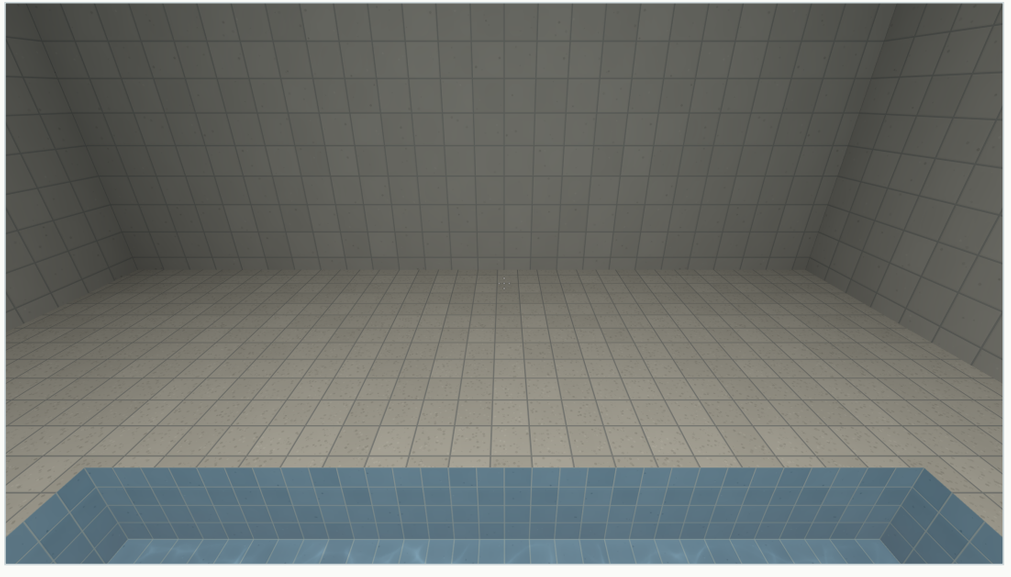
2. Walk into the Backrooms cabin. Aim at the destination control and press **E** or left click. Choose Home.

3. Let the doors close and the ride finish. Visit the bed and kitchen, then use Home’s cabin to reach Pool.

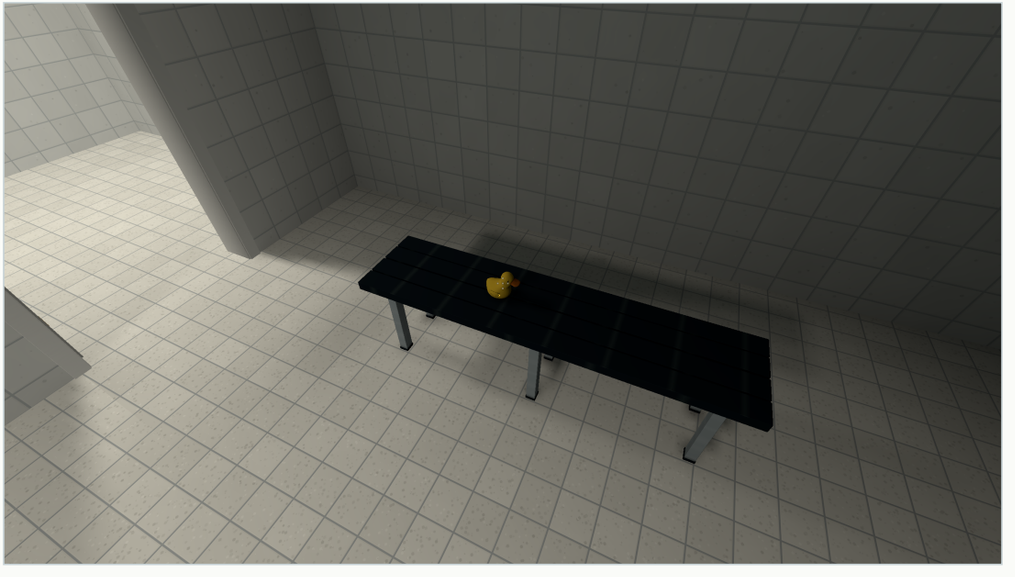
4. Enter the closet, walk into and out of the shallow basin, inspect the duck, then ride back to Backrooms. Try all return directions.

CHECKPOINT The separate green door-arrow button opens/closes doors at the current stop; it does not choose a destination. Clear the doorway if it keeps reopening.

25 Compare your finished Pool room



Standing in the shallow basin. The deck remains above the water.



The small rubber duck rests on the bench seat at Y = 0.45.

Pool: your basin should be visibly recessed, with water below the deck. The 0.4 m drop lets the player walk back out.

Furniture: keep the bench on the deck and the duck on the seat. The duck is a static decorative prop in this tutorial.

Closet: open the door, give it space to swing, then align with the centre of the gap. Check that its ceiling light illuminates the interior.

CHECKPOINT These are actual player captures from the compiled tutorial package. Editor inspect lighting will look different.

26 Your final checks and next steps

Geometry: every room has four enclosing walls. The Backrooms passage is an opening without a leaf. Home and the janitor closet have usable doors. No double floors or flickering surfaces.

Placement: the desk, chair, bed and kitchen stand on the floor. The pillars leave a walkable centre route. The bench is grounded, with the duck on its seat.

Lighting and water: each enclosed area has a fixture. Water stays inside the recessed basin. Inspect the finished compiled result, then adjust and rebuild if needed.

Travel and files: all three cabin names and return routes work. Save the project, export a fresh package after changes, and retain a backup of the entire editable folder.

If something goes wrong: Escape cancels the current tool; Cmd/Ctrl+Z undoes the last edit. Check the footer’s message. If a material changes the wrong object, Undo, select clear floor or the correct wall, and try again.

Continue learning: docs/EDITOR.md covers editor tools; docs/MAP_AUTHORING_GUIDE.md explains geometry and lighting; docs/ELEVATORS.md explains cabin limits. The companion editor-guide folder retains this guide’s editable source and original screenshots.

CHECKPOINT This walkthrough is scoped to the 0.13.1 native editor. Exact screenshots and validation details are recorded in editor-guide/README.md.